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GRAIN CART-SPECIFIC CONTROL SYSTEM FOR AUTOMATED GRAIN CART UNLOADING

Abstract

A grain cart-specific control system is configured to control a grain cart. A master control system interacts with the grain cart-specific control system in order to issue master control commands. The grain cart-specific control system receives the master control commands and executes grain cart-specific commands to carry out the master control commands.

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Background/Summary

FIELD OF THE DESCRIPTION

[0001] The present description relates to agricultural equipment. More specifically, the present description relates to automatically controlling a grain cart during an automated unloading operation.

BACKGROUND

[0002] There are a wide variety of different types of agricultural equipment. Some such agricultural equipment includes agricultural harvesters. Agricultural harvesters often engage crop, process that crop, and unload the crop into a receiving vehicle, such as a tractor-pulled grain cart.

[0003] Once the receiving vehicle is filled to a desired fill level with harvested material, a propulsion vehicle (such as a tractor or other vehicle) that pulls the receiving vehicle moves the harvested material in the grain cart to a container (such as a haulage vehicle—e.g., a semi-trailer) and transfers the harvested material from the grain cart to the container. The propulsion vehicle approaches the container, pulls alongside the container, and then engages an unloading auger on the grain cart to unload the harvested material from the grain cart into the container.

[0004] There are many different types of grain carts. Those grain carts may be controlled in a variety of different ways. For instance, the grain carts may be of different sizes and volume capacities. The unloading augers may fold or move from a transport position to a deployed, unload position, in different ways. There may be different types of actuators that are used for positioning the auger. Similarly, some unloading augers may be fitted with a spout that can be used to direct the trajectory of material as the material exits the auger. Further, the communication and control harness that attaches the grain cart to a control system on the propulsion vehicle may have a different configuration, depending upon the type of grain cart or the grain cart manufacturer.

[0005] The discussion above is merely provided for general background information and is not intended to be used as an aid in determining the scope of the claimed subject matter.

SUMMARY

[0006] A grain cart-specific control system is configured to control a grain cart. A master control system interacts with the grain cart-specific control system in order to issue master control commands. The grain cart-specific control system receives the master control commands and executes grain cart-specific commands to carry out the master control commands.

[0007] Example 1 is a computer implemented method of controlling a grain cart pulled by a propulsion vehicle, comprising: [0008] generating a master command with a master control system on the propulsion vehicle, the master command identifying a grain cart operation to be performed; [0009] receiving the master command at a grain cart-specific control system on the propulsion vehicle configured to generate a set of grain cart-specific commands based the master command; and [0010] generating a control signal with the grain cart-specific control system to control an actuator on the grain cart to execute the set of grain cart-specific commands.

[0011] Example 2 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein generating the master command with the master control system comprises: [0012] detecting that the grain cart is in an unloading position relative to a container; [0013] generating, as the master command, a power-up command commanding the grain cart-specific control system to perform a power-up sequence; and [0014] generating the control signal with the grain cart-specific control system to perform the power-up sequence.

[0015] Example 3 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein generating the control signal with the grain cart-specific control system to perform the power-up sequence comprises: [0016] generating control signals to control actuators on the grain cart to configure the grain cart for unloading material from the grain cart into the container.

[0017] Example 4 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein the propulsion vehicle has an engine, and the grain cart has an unloading auger and further comprising: [0018] after the auger is in a deployed position to perform an unloading operation,

generating an engine slow signal to slow a speed of the engine to a first speed; [0019] generating an engage pto signal to engage a power takeoff; and [0020] generating an engine fast signal to control the speed of the engine to a second speed, faster than the first speed.

[0021] Example 5 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein the grain cart has a gate that opens to allow material to flow to the auger and wherein generating control signals to control actuators on the grain cart to configure the grain cart for unloading material from the grain cart into the container comprises: [0022] generating an open gate signal to control a gate actuator to move the gate into an open position.

[0023] Example 6 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein generating a master command comprises generating an unload rate request indicative of a requested rate at which material is unloaded from the grain cart to the container, wherein generating the control signal with the grain cart-specific control system comprises: [0024] generating a gate actuator control signal to control a position of the gate based on the unload rate request.

[0025] Example 7 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein generating a master command comprises generating an auger unfold command and wherein generating a control signal with the grain cart-specific control system comprises: [0026] generating an auger position control signal to control an auger position actuator to move the auger to the deployed position based on the auger unfold command.

[0027] Example 8 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein the grain cart includes a spout and a spout position actuator that positions the spout and wherein generating a control signal with the grain cart-specific control system comprises: [0028] generating a spout position control signal to control the spout position actuator to move the spout into the deployed position based on the auger unfold command.

[0029] Example 9 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein generating the master command comprises: [0030] detecting that an unloading operation is complete; and [0031] generating, as the master command, a command for the grain cart-specific control system, to perform a power down sequence and further comprising generating the control signal with the grain cart-specific control system to perform the power down sequence.

[0032] Example 10 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein generating the control signal with the grain cart-specific control system to perform the power down sequence comprises: [0033] generating a gate close signal to control the gate actuator to move the gate to a closed position; [0034] controlling the auger to run for a clean out time period; [0035] generating an engine slow signal to slow a speed of the engine to the first speed; [0036] generating a disengage pto signal to disengage the power takeoff; and [0037] generating an engine fast signal to control the speed of the engine to the second speed, faster than the first speed.

[0038] Example 11 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein generating a master command comprises generating an auger fold command and wherein generating a control signal with the grain cart-specific control system comprises: [0039] generating an auger position control signal to control the auger position actuator to move the auger to the folded position based on the auger fold command.

[0040] Example 12 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples and further comprising: [0041] accessing grain cart-specific configuration values; and [0042] configuring the grain cart-specific control system, based on the grain cart-specific configuration values, to generate the grain cart-specific commands.

[0043] Example 13 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein accessing grain cart-specific configuration values comprises: [0044] detecting a grain cart identifier identifying the grain cart; and [0045] downloading a grain cart model based on the grain cart identifier.

[0046] Example 14 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein accessing grain cart-specific configuration values comprises: [0047] conducting a configuration

user experience to receive user configuration inputs indicative of a configuration of the grain cart.

[0048] Example 15 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein conducting a configuration user experience to receive user configuration inputs comprises: [0049] generating an interactive display; [0050] prompting, on the interactive display, user manipulation of an actuator on the grain cart; [0051] detecting configuration information based on the user manipulation of the actuator on the grain cart; and [0052] saving the configuration data corresponding to a grain cart identifier identifying the grain cart.

[0053] Example 16 is a control system on a propulsion vehicle for controlling a grain cart propelled by the propulsion vehicle, the control system comprising: [0054] a master control system configured to generate a grain cart independent master command identifying a grain cart operation to be performed; [0055] a grain cart-specific control system configured to receive the master command and generate a set of grain cart-specific commands based the master command to control an actuator on the grain cart to execute the set of grain cart-specific commands; and [0056] a grain cart control configuration system configured to access grain cart-specific configuration values and configure the grain cart-specific control system, based on the grain cart-specific configuration values, to generate the grain cart-specific commands.

[0057] Example 17 is the control system of any or all previous examples wherein the master control system comprises: [0058] a vehicle position control system configured to detect that the grain cart is in an unloading position relative to a container; [0059] an unload operation control system configured to generate, as the master command, a power-up command commanding the grain cart-specific control system to perform a power-up sequence.

[0060] Example 18 is the control system of any or all previous examples wherein the master control system comprises: [0061] a fill strategy controller configured to detect when an unloading operation is complete; and an unload operation control system configured to generate, as the master command, [0062] a power down command commanding the grain cart-specific control system to perform a power down sequence.

[0063] Example 19 is the control system of any or all previous examples wherein the grain cart includes a gate and a gate actuator and further comprising an unload rate request generator configured to generate an unload rate request indicative of a requested rate at which material is unloaded from the grain cart to the container and wherein the grain cart-specific control system comprises: [0064] a gate controller configured to generate a gate actuator control signal to control the gate actuator to control a position of the gate based on the unload rate request.

[0065] Example 20 is a propulsion vehicle that propels a grain cart, comprising: [0066] an engine; [0067] a propulsion subsystem; [0068] a steering subsystem; [0069] a master control system configured to generate a master command, the master command identifying a grain cart operation to be performed; [0070] a grain cart-specific control system configured to receive the master command and generate a set of grain cart-specific commands based the master command; and [0071] a controller configured to generate a control signal to control an actuator on the grain cart to execute the set of grain cart-specific commands.

[0072] This Summary is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the Detailed Description. This Summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used as an aid in determining the scope of the claimed subject matter. The claimed subject matter is not limited to implementations that solve any or all disadvantages noted in the background.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0073] FIG. 1 is a pictorial illustration of one example of an agricultural system.

[0074] FIGS. 2A, 2B, and 2C show one example of a grain cart in a plurality of different positions.

[0075] FIG. 3A is a state diagram illustrating the states of one example of a master control system.

[0076] FIG. 3B is a state diagram illustrating the states of one example of a grain cart-specific control system.

[0077] FIGS. 4A and 4B (collectively referred to herein as FIG. 4) illustrate a block diagram showing one example of a portion of an agricultural system (with a towing vehicle and grain cart) in more detail.

[0078] FIG. 5 is a flow diagram illustrating one example of configuring a grain cart-specific control system to control a specific grain cart.

[0079] FIG. 6 is a flow diagram showing one example of the operation of an agricultural system in which a grain cart and towing vehicle approach a container, unload material into the container, and prepare to leave the container.

[0080] FIGS. 7A and 7B (collectively referred to herein as FIG. 7) are a flow diagram showing one example of the operation of the grain cart-specific control system in controlling an auger and spout of a grain cart illustrated in FIGS. 2A, 2B, and 2C.

[0081] FIG. 8 is a block diagram showing one example of the agricultural system shown in FIG. 1 deployed in a remote server environment.

[0082] FIGS. 9, 10, and 11 show examples of mobile devices that can be used in the architectures and systems shown in other figures.

[0083] FIG. 12 is a block diagram showing one example of a computing environment that can be used in architectures and systems shown in other figures.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0084] As discussed above, there are a wide variety of different types of grain carts that can be used as receiving vehicles in a harvesting operation. In order to perform automated unloading of the grain cart into a container (such as a haulage vehicle—e.g., a semi-trailer) it is therefore difficult to generate a control system that can be used to control a wide variety of different grain carts, because there are so many differences in the way grain carts are configured and controlled.

[0085] The present discussion thus proceeds with respect to a description of a system in which a master control system is used to issue high level commands to control a grain cart during an unloading operation. A grain cart-specific control system is used to carry out the high-level commands on a specific grain cart. The grain cart-specific control system can be configured for the specific grain cart and can then be used to interpret the high-level commands and generate control signals to take steps to execute those high-level commands on a specific grain cart. Therefore, the control system need not be redesigned for every specific grain cart. Instead, the master control system can be used across a plurality of different types and configurations of grain carts and the grain cart-specific control system can be configured automatically or through an operator or user interface for any of a wide variety of different specific types of grain carts.

[0086] FIG. 1 is a pictorial illustration of one example of an agricultural system **100** in which a harvester **102** is moving through a field in the direction indicated by arrow **104**. A receiving vehicle **106** includes a propulsion vehicle (e.g., a tractor) **108** and a grain cart **110**. Grain cart **100** is shown having an auger **112** and spout **114** that are used to unload harvested material from grain cart **110**. In the example shown in FIG. 1, grain cart **110** has been filled with harvested material from harvester **102** and is traveling along a travel path indicated by arrow **116** toward a container (e.g., a semi-truck) **118**. In order to unload material from grain cart **110**, tractor **108** pulls the grain cart **110** along the side of semi-trailer **120** so that the auger **112** can be engaged to transfer material from grain cart **110** into semi-trailer **120**. In one example, auger **112** is driven by a power takeoff on tractor **108**.

[0087] Grain cart **110** is, in one example, fitted at its lower end with a gate **111** which can be opened to allow grain to pass out of grain cart **110** and into a hopper or another container that feeds auger **112**. The extent to which gate **111** is opened along with the speed of rotation of auger **112**,

determine the rate at which harvested material is removed from grain cart **110** and loaded into semi-trailer **120**.

[0088] Also, in the example shown in FIG. **1**, an unloading control system **122** can be deployed on tractor **108**, grain cart **110**, in a remote server environment, or disbursed among a plurality of different locations. Unloading control system **122**, in one example, generates control signals to automatically control the unloading of harvested material from grain cart **110** into semi-trailer **120**. Unloading control system **122** is described in greater detail below. By “automatically”, it is meant that the operation or function can be carried out without further human involvement except, perhaps, to initiate or authorize the operation or function.

[0089] Thus, as tractor **108** approaches semi-trailer **120**, unloading control system **122** can detect that tractor **108** is approaching semi-trailer **120**. Then, when in sensor range of sensors on receiving vehicle **106**, unloading control system **122** can sense the position of semi-trailer **120** and generate control signals to control the propulsion and steering subsystems on tractor **108** to automatically move tractor **108** (and thus grain cart **110**) along semi-trailer **120** to fill semi-trailer **120** with harvested material according to a fill strategy (such as a front-to-back fill strategy, a back-to-front fill strategy, a multi-pass fill strategy, etc.).

[0090] As discussed elsewhere herein, there are many different types of grain carts **110**. For example, in some grain carts, the auger **112** is foldable along multiple different axes. Further, spout **114** may be movable along different axes. In addition, the mechanisms or actuators for changing the position of auger **112** and spout **114** may be different from one grain cart to the next. The speed at which the auger **112** is driven may be different as well.

[0091] In addition, the configuration of the actuator for opening and closing gate **111** may also be different among different grain carts.

[0092] Therefore, in one example, unloading control system **122** has a master control system that generates high level commands (or master commands) for controlling grain cart **110** during the unloading operation, as well as a grain cart-specific control system which is configured to generate grain cart-specific control signals to carry out the master commands generated by the control system. For instance, the master control system may generate a control command to deploy auger **112** to its unloading position. The grain cart-specific control system then generates the specific control signals used by the specific grain cart **110** (or the specific type of grain cart **110**) to properly actuate the particular actuators on grain cart **110** that are used to move auger **112** from a transport position to a deployed, unloading position. This is just one example and other examples of the operation of the master control system and grain cart-specific control system are discussed elsewhere herein.

[0093] Therefore, in one example, a master command is a command that applies to multiple different types of grain carts, such as to deploy the auger and spout, start unloading, stop unloading, fold the auger and spout, etc., but which is carried out differently on the different types of grain carts. The grain cart-specific commands are commands used to control a specific type of grain cart to carry out or execute a master command.

[0094] For purposes of example, FIGS. **2A**, **2B**, and **2C** are pictorial illustrations of one example of a grain cart **110**. FIG. **2A** shows that auger **112** and spout **114** are in a road transport position. Such a position may be suitable when a propulsion vehicle tows grain cart **110** over a road. In the example shown in FIG. **2B**, grain cart **110** is configured with auger **112** and spout **114** in a field transport position. The field transport position may be used when the propulsion vehicle **108** is towing grain cart **110** between harvester **102** and container **118**. FIG. **2C** shows grain cart **110** with auger **112** and spout **114** in a deployed or unload position. In the example shown in FIG. **2C**, grain cart **110** is configured with a movable spout **114** which can be moved generally along the direction indicated by arrow **124**. Thus, spout **114** can be moved to change the trajectory of material exiting auger **112**.

[0095] As noted, there are a wide variety of different types of grain carts. Some grain carts do not

have a road transport position and a field transport position. Other grain carts have a foldable auger **112**. Further, as discussed above, different grain carts may have different gate configurations in which the gate **111** on one grain cart can be opened to a greater or lesser extent than the gate **111** on another grain cart. In addition, different grain carts may have different sensors that sense the position of auger **112** and spout **114**, the position of the gate **111**, etc. Also, different grain carts may have actuators for driving movement of auger **112**, spout **114**, and gate **111** using different voltages or different types of control signals. Further, the wiring harness or other communication and power harness that couples grain cart **110** to the towing vehicle **108** may have different pin configurations or different wiring configurations, depending upon the grain cart. Thus, as discussed above, it can be very difficult to design a single control system to automatically control different kinds of grain carts **110** during an unload operation. The present description thus proceeds with respect to a configurable system that includes a master control system and a grain cart-specific control system. [0096] FIG. 3A is a simplified state diagram showing one example of the different states of the master control system, and FIG. 3B is a simplified state diagram showing one example of the states of the grain cart-specific control system. In FIG. 3A, the master control system can start in a manual state indicated by block **126**. In the manual state, the master control system operates as if no automation is enabled. This allows for normal manual operation of the towing vehicle and grain cart. When the master control system is in the enabled state, as indicated by block **128**, then the master control system responds to operator inputs but does not perform any automated operations without an operator input. In the approach state **130**, the master control system begins to detect the container **118**, as well as its distance and pose. The master control system can begin automatically controlling the propulsion and steering subsystems on towing vehicle **108** to approach the semi-trailer **120**. In the detect trailer state **132**, the on-board sensors on towing vehicle **108** have detected the semi-trailer **120** and the master control system may issue a master command requesting that the auger **112** be positioned in the deployed position. The master control system can also begin controlling the propulsion and steering subsystems on the towing vehicle **108** to nudge the towing vehicle **108** along the side of trailer **120** to reach a desired location to begin the unload operation. In the filling state **134**, the master control system will issue master commands to begin unloading grain cart **110** and filling semi-trailer **120**. The master control system can generate unload rate requests indicating the desired rate at which harvested material should be unloaded from grain cart **110**. This allows the grain cart-specific control system to control the gate **111** on grain cart **110** and the speed of the engine in order to achieve the desired unloading rate. The master control system can also generate master commands to move the grain cart along the side of semi-trailer **120** in order to execute a desired fill strategy. In the stop fill state **136**, the master control system issues a master command commanding the grain cart-specific control system to stop unloading. This may occur, for instance, when the semi-trailer **120** is full, or for other reasons. In the prepare for travel state **138**, the master control system can generate master commands commanding the grain cart to be moved back into a desired configuration for transport back to the harvester **102**, such as by folding auger **112**, and/or taking other steps.

[0097] At any time during operation, the master control system can enter a fault state in which automation is stopped in a manner that will minimize damage to the system when certain fault conditions occur, such as when a spill is detected, when an operator input is detected, or when other fault conditions are detected. In the fault state the master control system generates master commands to shut down the grain cart operation as well.

[0098] FIG. 3B shows that the state model for the grain cart-specific control system also includes a manual state **140** in which no automation is carried out. In the enabled state **142**, the control system responds to operator inputs and will only automate operations based on operator inputs. In the unfold state **144**, the grain cart-specific control system will extend auger **112** to the deployed position. In the start unload state **146**, the grain cart-specific control system will perform grain cart-specific control operations to go through a startup sequence, described in greater detail below with

respect to FIG. 6. In the unloading state **148**, the grain cart-specific control system controls the gate **111** to meet the requested unload rate that is provided by the master control system, during an unloading operation. In the stop unload state **150**, the grain cart-specific control system goes through a shutdown sequence which is also described in greater detail below with respect to FIG. 6. In the prepare for travel state **152**, the grain cart-specific control system controls the actuators on the grain cart to place the grain cart back in condition for transport. The grain cart can be placed in a field transport configuration (as shown in FIG. 2B) or a road transport configuration (as shown in 2A), etc. The grain cart-specific control system can also reach a fault state in which automation is stopped.

[0099] In one example, there may be a plurality of different fault states. For instance, in a fault stop state, a fault condition is detected in which the system goes through a shutdown sequence and then disables automation. In a fault out-state, a fault condition is detected in which the system immediately disables automation without shutting down the current operating sequence (e.g., the operation of the grain cart **110** remains as is when the fault out condition is detected. These are only examples and other fault states may be implemented as well.

[0100] FIGS. 4A and 4B (collectively referred to herein as FIG. 4) illustrate a block diagram showing one example of receiving vehicle **106** in which towing vehicle **108** and grain cart **110** are shown in more detail. In the example shown in FIG. 4, towing vehicle **108** includes one or more processors or servers **160**, data store **162**, communication system **164**, sensors **166**, grain cart control configuration system **168**, operator interface **169**, unloading control system **122**, engine **170**, controllable subsystems **172**, and other towing vehicle functionality **174**. Grain cart **110** includes auger position actuator(s) **176**, spout position actuator(s) **178**, gate actuator **180**, sensors **182**, controllable subsystems **184**, and other grain cart functionality **186**. FIG. 4 also shows that the towing vehicle **108** is coupled to grain cart **110** over link **188**. Link **188** can be a mechanical link, as well as an electrical link and/or other link. The link **188** can transmit power (such as PTO power, hydraulic power, electric power, etc.) to grain cart **110**. Link **188** can be a unidirectional or bidirectional communication link that communicates control signals and/or other signals. Link **188** can include a wireless link as well. Data store **162** can include grain cart model **190**, grain cart configuration data **192**, and other items **194**. Sensors **166** can include position sensor **196**, container sensor **198**, engine speed sensor **200**, fill level sensor **202**, and other items **204**. Grain cart control configuration system **168** can include user interface processing system **206**, grain cart identification system **208**, data store interaction system **210**, configuration data capturing system **211**, configuration prompting system **212**, configuration verification system **214**, and other items **216**. Operator interface **169** can include a steering wheel, joy sticks, pedals, levers, display screens, other audio, visual, and/or haptic devices for generating outputs to an operator and receiving inputs from an operator. Unloading control system **122** can include master control system **218**, grain cart-specific control system **220**, and other items **222**. In the example shown in FIG. 4, master control system **218** includes trigger detector **224**, fault detector **226**, vehicle position control system **228**, unload operation control system **230**, and other items **232**. Unload operation control system **230** can include unload rate request generator **234**, fill level detector **236**, fill strategy controller **238**, master control signal generator **240**, and other items **242**. Grain cart-specific control system **220** can include auger/spout actuator controller **244**, engine speed controller **246**, PTO engagement controller **248**, unload rate request processor **250**, gate controller **252**, clean out timer **254**, and other items **256**. Controllable subsystems **172** can include propulsion subsystem **258**, steering subsystem **260**, power takeoff subsystem **262**, and other items **264**.

[0101] On grain cart **110**, sensors **182** can include gate position sensor **266**, auger/spout position sensors **268**, fill level sensor **270**, and other items **272**. Controllable subsystems **184** can include auger **112**, spout **114**, gate **111**, and other items **274**. Before describing the overall operation of agricultural system **100** and receiving vehicle **106**, a description of some of the items on receiving vehicle **106**, and their operation, will first be described.

[0102] Grain cart model **190** may be data that models the grain cart **110**. For instance, grain cart model **190** may include information indicating the type of auger **112** and spout **114**, the pin configuration on a wiring harness which forms part of link **188**, the different voltage levels that may be used to control grain cart **110**, the sensors that are used, among other things. Grain cart model **190** may be indexed in data store **162** based on the make and model of the grain cart that is modeled, based upon the type of grain cart that is modeled, based on a specific cart identifier, or in other ways.

[0103] Grain cart configuration data **192** can include data that is similar to that in grain cart model **190**, but that is generated by grain cart control configuration system **168** in response to operator inputs. Grain cart configuration data **192** can also be indexed based upon the make and model of grain cart **110**, based upon another identifier of grain cart **110**, based upon the type of grain cart **110**, or in other ways.

[0104] Communication system **164** facilitates the communication of items on towing vehicle **108** and grain cart **110** with one another. Therefore, communication system **164** can include a controller area network (CAN) bus and bus controller. Communication system **164** can also facilitate the communication between towing vehicle **108** and grain cart **110** or with other systems or vehicles. Therefore, communication system **164** can include a wide area network communication system, a local area network communication system, a Bluetooth or Wi-Fi communication system, a near field communication system, a cellular communication system, or any of a wide variety of other systems or combinations of systems.

[0105] Position sensor **196** can generate an output indicative of the position of position sensor **196** in a global or local coordinate system. Position sensor **196** may be a global navigation satellite system (GNSS) receiver, a cellular triangulation system, a dead reckoning system, or any of a wide variety of other position sensors. Container sensor **198** illustratively includes one or more sensors or detectors that can detect the location and orientation of container **118** (and in the present example, trailer **120**). Therefore, container sensor **198** can include an optical sensor (such as a stereo camera with an image processing system), a RADAR sensor, a LIDAR sensor, an ultrasound sensor, an ultrawide band sensor, or other sensors. Engine speed sensor **200** generates an output indicative of the engine speed of engine **170**. Engine speed sensor **200** can sense the output of engine **170**, a throttle input to engine **170**, or another variable indicative of the speed of engine **170**. Fill level sensor **202** may be an optical sensor or another sensor that is used to detect a fill level of material in grain cart **110** and/or a fill level of material in trailer **120**. Fill level sensor **202** may be a camera located on towing vehicle **108** that is positioned (such as on auger **112**) with a field of view inside grain cart **110** and/or a camera that is positioned with a field of view inside trailer **120** when receiving vehicle **106** is alongside trailer **120** to unload material into trailer **120**. The fill level sensor **202** may provide an output indicative of the fill level or an output that can be processed to derive the fill level (such as using image processing or other signal processing).

[0106] Grain cart control configuration system **168** is used to generate a user experience so that a user (such as a technician, an operator, or another user) can configure grain cart-specific control system **220** for a grain cart **110**. In one example, user interface processing system **206** generates a user interface on operator interface system **169** for interaction by an operator or another user. Grain cart identification system **208** identifies the particular grain cart **110** for which the grain cart-specific control system **220** is being configured. Thus, grain cart identification system **208** can automatically read an identifier on grain cart **110** or generate a user input mechanism that allows the operator or user to select the grain cart or otherwise specify the type of grain cart.

[0107] Data store interaction system **210** can extract grain cart configuration data **192** or grain cart model **190** from data store **162**, and can also store grain cart configuration data **192** or a grain cart model **190** that is obtained through user interface processing system **206** for later use by grain cart-specific control system **220**. Configuration prompting system **212** prompts the operator or other user for values that are needed to generate the grain cart configuration data **192** or grain cart model

190. For instance, Table 1 shows one example of instructions that can be used so that the operator or user performs operations and enters data (or so capturing system **112** automatically captures data) that can be used to generate the grain cart configuration data **192** or grain cart model **190**.

Table 1

[0108] Allow the operator to access the screen and request to configure the system [0109] Configure the following functions [0110] Gate Open [0111] Gate Closed [0112] Auger Folded [0113] Auger Extended [0114] Spout pointed Outbound [0115] Spout pointed Inbound [0116] Configure as follows [0117] Request that the operator use a control paddle to perform the following: [0118] Open the Gate all the way and acknowledge maintaining for 4 seconds [0119] Close the gate so it is approximately 95% open. Acknowledge [0120] Close the Gate all the way to acknowledge maintaining for 4 seconds [0121] Open the gate so it is approximately 5% open. Acknowledge [0122] Fold the Auger all the way and acknowledge maintaining for 4 seconds [0123] Extend the Auger so it is a few degrees from folded. Acknowledge [0124] Extend the Auger all the way and acknowledge maintaining for 4 seconds [0125] Fold the Auger so it is a few degrees from extended. Acknowledge [0126] Point the Spout fully inbound and acknowledge maintaining for 4 seconds [0127] At this time the software will have detected the following [0128] Which control paddle is performing the function [0129] The flow direction to perform the function (left port or right port) [0130] The sensor pin for the function (if there is one) [0131] The values of the sensor voltage detection threshold [0132] The value of the sensor voltage undetected threshold [0133] Request that the operator allow further calibration checks [0134] Cycle through each function at full flow [0135] Cycle through each function at $\frac{2}{3}$ of full flow [0136] Cycle through each function at $\frac{1}{3}$ of full flow [0137] While going through the function, record the length of time to go from extended to retracted position at various flow rates

[0138] Configuration verification system **214** can be used to verify the configuration data entered by the operator or user or automatically detected by configuration prompting system **212** and configuration data capture system **211**. Configuration data capture system **211** can be used to capture or sense configuration data based upon user or operator inputs. For instance, the user or operator may be instructed to perform an operation (e.g., to open gate **111** all the way). At that point, configuration data capture system **211** may capture any configuration data corresponding to the gate **111** in the open position. This is just one example, as are the specific operations and configuration data shown in Table 1.

[0139] Master control system **218** performs high-level operations and generates high-level control commands (master commands) that are passed to grain cart-specific control system **220** and controllable subsystems **172**. Grain cart-specific control system **220** then performs more fine-grained grain cart-specific operations to execute the master commands received by master control system **218**. Some examples are described in greater detail below with respect to FIGS. 6, 7A, and 7B.

[0140] Trigger detector **224** detects conditions that indicate whether master control system **218** is in the manual state **126**, or any of the other states illustrated in FIG. 3A. Fault detector **226** detects fault conditions. Vehicle position control system **228** detects the relative positions of receiving vehicle **106** and container **118** and controls the propulsion subsystem **258** and steering subsystem **260** to bring the two vehicles into close proximity relative to one another so that material can be unloaded from grain cart **110** into trailer **120**. Unloading operation control system **230** can receive sensor inputs and/or other inputs and generate the master commands to perform an unloading operation. Unload rate request generator **234** generates an output indicative of a requested unloading rate. This can be used by unload rate request processor **250** to control how far to open gate **111** and how fast to control engine **170** (and thus the speed of power takeoff subsystem **262**). Fill level detector **236** can receive an input from fill level sensor **202** and detect the fill level of trailer **120** to determine when the current location (where material is being loaded) in trailer **120** is filled to a desired level. Fill strategy controller **238** can use the fill level to determine when to

control the vehicle position controller **228** to nudge the position of vehicle **106** relative to trailer **120** to fill trailer **120** according to a desired fill strategy (such as a front-to-back fill strategy, a back-to-front fill strategy, etc.). Master control signal generator **240** generates control signals indicative of the master commands (e.g., the nudge operations, the requested unloading rate, start/stop filling, auger fold/unfold, etc.), and provides those to grain cart-specific control system **220** and controllable subsystems **172**, as needed.

[0141] Grain cart-specific control system **220** receives the master commands from master control system **218** and generates the grain cart-specific control signals to control grain cart **110** to execute the master commands. Auger/spout actuator controller **244** generates control signals to control the auger position actuators **176** and spout position actuator(s) **178** on grain cart **110**. Therefore, auger/spout actuator controller **244** is programmed with the appropriate voltage ranges, pin configuration, timing parameters, etc., to generate the appropriate signal to control the position of auger **112** and spout **114** (by controlling auger position actuators **176** and spout position actuators **178**) to unfold, fold, move to the road transport position, move to the field transport position, etc., based upon the master commands from unload operation control system **230**.

[0142] Engine speed controller **246** generates a control signal to control the speed of engine **170**. The speed of engine **170** can be controlled in order to change the speed of power takeoff subsystem **262** to thus change the unload rate from grain cart **110**. PTO engagement controller **248** controls the engagement of power takeoff system **262**, and the disengagement of power takeoff system **262**. Engine speed controller **246** and PTO engagement controller **248** can operate so that the engine speed **170** is reduced before power takeoff subsystem **262** is engaged or disengaged. Unload rate request processor **250** receives the unload rate request generated by unload rate request generator **234**. Unload rate request processor **250** processes that request to determine the engine speed and gate position that should be used to reach the requested unload rate. Gate controller **252** generates control signals to control gate actuator **180** so that the position of gate **111** can be controlled. The position of gate **111** can also be modified to modify the unload rate. Clean out timer **254** can be set to different values, based upon the dimensions of auger **112**, the speed of the auger **112**, etc. Once gate **111** is closed, the auger **112** is cleaned out so that auger **112** runs for a given clean out time period after gate **111** is closed to remove all the harvested material from auger **112**. Thus, clean out timer **254** may be a programmable timer, or a static timer that counts out a clean out time period once gate **111** is closed.

[0143] Propulsion subsystem **258** can be a transmission that is connected to the output of engine **170**, or motors that drive ground engaging elements of towing vehicle **108** individually or in sets, or other propulsion elements. Steering subsystem **260** can include steerable wheels, skid steer wheels or tracks, or other controllable elements that can be controlled to change the heading or orientation of towing vehicle **108**. Power takeoff subsystem **262** is a power takeoff that can be engaged and disengaged and that can be connected to unloading auger **112** in order to drive unloading auger **112** to move material from grain cart **110** to container **118**.

[0144] On grain cart **110**, auger position actuators **176** can be hydraulic, electric, electro-mechanical, pneumatic, or other actuators that are coupled to auger **112** to position auger **112** in the various positions (such as those shown in FIGS. 2A-2C). Spout position actuators **178** can also be any type of actuator that is used to position spout **114** relative to auger **112**, as desired, in order to adjust the trajectory of material exiting spout **114**. Gate actuator **180** is actuated to change the position of gate **111** between a fully open position and a fully closed position. Gate position sensor **266** senses the position of gate **111**. Sensor **266** can thus be a Hall effect sensor, a sensor that senses the position of gate actuator **180**, or other sensor. Auger/spout position sensors **268** sense the position of auger **112** and spout **114**. Fill level sensor **270** may be the same as or different from fill level sensor **202**. For instance, fill level sensor **270** may be a camera, such as a mono or stereo camera, or another sensor that senses the level of material in grain cart **110** and/or in container **118**. By way of example, fill level sensor **270** may be a camera mounted on auger **112** and positioned to

capture an image of the interior of container **118** during the unloading operation. Fill level detector **236** can receive a signal from fill level sensor **270** and generate an output indicative of the fill level within container **118**. Grain cart **110** can include a wide variety of other functionality **186** as well. [0145] FIG. 5 is a flow diagram illustrating one example of the operation of grain cart control configuration system **168** in directing a user experience so that a user can configure the grain cart-specific control system **220**. It is first assumed that master control system **218** is deployed on towing vehicle **108**, as indicated by block **280** in the flow diagram of FIG. 5. Also, grain cart-specific control system **220** is deployed for configuration to control a particular grain cart **110**, as indicated by block **282**.

[0146] Grain cart identification system **208** detects a grain cart identifier on grain cart **110**, which identifies grain cart **110** for configuration system **168**. Detecting a grain cart identifier is indicated by block **284** in the flow diagram of FIG. 5. Grain cart identification system **208** can use an optical or other sensor to sense an identifier located on grain cart **110** (such as a fiducial marker, another identifying tag, etc.). Identifying the grain cart using an optical or other sensor is indicated by block **286** in the flow diagram of FIG. 5. Grain cart identification system **208** can also receive an operator input **288** that identifies the grain cart. The grain cart can be identified based on the make and/or model of the grain cart, as indicated by block **290**, the type of grain cart, as indicated by block **292**, or another type of identifier, as indicated by block **294**.

[0147] Once the cart is identified, data store interaction system **210** searches data store **162** to determine whether a cart configuration model (e.g., grain cart model) **190**, or whether grain cart configuration data **192** is already available for this particular grain cart or type of grain cart. Determining whether a grain cart model **190** or grain cart configuration data **192** is available for this grain cart is indicated by block **296** in the flow diagram of FIG. 5.

[0148] If a grain cart model **190** or grain cart configuration data **192** is already available, then data store interaction system **210** downloads and installs that model or the configuration data to configure grain cart-specific control system **220** with the values it needs to translate the master commands received by master control system **218** into the grain cart-specific commands needed to execute those master commands. Downloading and installing the grain cart configuration model or other grain cart configuration data is indicated by block **298** in the flow diagram of FIG. 5.

[0149] If, at block **296**, data store interaction system **210** determines that there is no grain cart model **190** or grain cart configuration data **192** for the identified grain cart **110**, then configuration prompting system **212** generates a user experience for a user to manually generate the grain cart configuration model **190** or to otherwise enter the grain cart configuration data **192**, as indicated by block **300** in the flow diagram of FIG. 5. Configuration data capture system **211** can also be used to automatically capture data, based upon user inputs or in other ways.

[0150] As one example, configuration prompting system **212** displays one or more interactive setup screens that prompt the user for values that will be used by grain cart-specific control system **220** to control grain cart **110**. Displaying the interactive setup screens is indicated by block **302** in the flow diagram of FIG. 5. Those setup screens may instruct the user how to manually manipulate grain cart **110** so that values can automatically be detected or captured by configuration data capture system **211**. For instance, the interactive screens may prompt the user to open gate **111** all the way. At that point configuration data capture system **211** may capture data (such as from the gate position sensor **266** or other data) that is indicative of the current position of gate **111**, which pins were used to control gate **111**, the signal levels used to control gate **111**, etc. The interactive screens may prompt the operator to manually control the actuators to move the auger **112** to the different positions (such as those shown in FIG. 2A-2C) and configuration data capture system **211** can then capture data indicative of the auger **112** being in the different positions. The same can be done for spout **114**, for power takeoff engagement and disengagement, for engine speed, and/or any of the other controllable elements on grain cart **110**. Configuration data capture system **211** can also capture the pins or pin configuration used by grain cart **110** that contain data to be captured, the

pins that are used to control actuators or other elements on grain cart **110**, the voltage levels and timing parameters of the control signals, etc. Instructing the user how to manually manipulate grain cart **110** so that data can be captured is indicated by block **304** in the flow diagram of FIG. 5. Learning the control configuration, or capturing the configuration data is indicated by block **306**. [0151] Configuration verification system **214** can then verify grain cart control by cycling through different operations and asking a user to provide an input affirming that the desired operation was completed. For instance, the interactive setup screens **302** can indicate to the user that the system is attempting to move auger **112** from its road transport position to its deployed, unload position. The screen can also prompt the user to provide an input indicating whether the auger was properly moved between those two positions. In another example, the display screen may indicate that the grain cart-specific control system **220** is attempting to open gate **111** and then close gate **111**, and ask the operator for an input verifying if and when those operations were successfully completed. This can be done to allow the operator to verify any or all other control operations as well. Verifying control by cycling through various operations and asking for manual verification is indicated by block **308** in the flow diagram of FIG. 5. Table 1 above shows one example of items that can be displayed on an interactive setup screen **302** generated for an operator. Generating a user experience can be done in other ways as well, in order to capture the configuration model **190** or configuration data **192**, as indicated by block **310**.

[0152] FIG. 6 is a flow diagram illustrating one example of the operation of unloading control system **122** after grain cart-specific control system **220** has been configured with the grain cart model **190** or grain cart configuration data **192** for the grain cart **110** that is being controlled.

[0153] It is first assumed that the unloading control system **122** is enabled to perform automated unloading operations, as indicated by block **312** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6.

[0154] Vehicle position control system **228** detects that towing vehicle **108** is approaching container **118**. This can be detected in a wide variety of different ways. For instance, container **118** may be parked at a predefined location, or may be transmitting its global positioning coordinates or other coordinates so that its position can be compared with the current position of towing vehicle **108** generated by position sensor **196**. Detecting that towing vehicle **108** is approaching container **118** is indicated by block **314** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6. This may act as a trigger for trigger detector **224** to indicate that unloading operation control system **230** should begin performing the automated unloading operation. Master control signal generator **240** then generates a master command to grain cart-specific control system **220** to deploy the auger **112** and spout **114** to the deployed position. Generating such a command is indicated by block **316** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6.

[0155] Once grain cart-specific control system **220** receives the command to deploy the spout **112** and auger **114**, grain cart-specific control system **220** controls the auger position actuator **176** and spout position actuator **178** to deploy the auger and spout. One example of this is described in greater detail below with respect to FIG. 7.

[0156] Vehicle position control system **228** then detects container **118** (e.g., container sensors **198** may detect the container **118**). Detecting the container **118** with the sensors **198** on board towing vehicle **108** is indicated by block **318** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6.

[0157] Vehicle position control system **228** then controls the controllable subsystems **172** to position grain cart **110** along the side of container **118** for unloading, as indicated by block **320** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6. Until grain cart **110** is in the unloading position adjacent container **118**, vehicle position control system **228** continues to move the grain cart **110** into the unloading position, as indicated by block **322** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6.

[0158] Once the two vehicles are in the proper unload position relative to one another, unload control system **230** issues a master command to grain cart-specific control system **220** to perform a startup sequence. Unload rate request generator **234** also provides an unload rate request indicating a requested rate at which material is to be unloaded. Commanding the grain cart-specific control

system **220** to perform a startup sequence is indicated by block **224** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6. In order to perform its startup sequence to prepare to unload, engine speed controller **246** generates a control signal to control engine **170** to slow the engine speed, as indicated by block **326**. PTO engagement controller **248** then generates a control signal to engage the power takeoff subsystem **262**, as indicated by block **328**, and engine speed controller **246** then generates a control signal to again increase the engine speed of engine **170**, as indicated by block **330** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6. Gate controller **252** then generates a control signal to control gate actuator **180** to open gate **111**. Opening gate **111** is indicated by block **332** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6. Thus, the gate **111** is not opened until the PTO is engaged, and the engine speed is increased.

[0159] Unload operation control system **230** then generates control signals to perform an unloading operation. Unload rate request generator **234** generates unload rate requests and provides them as master commands to unload rate request processor **250**. The engine speed, PTO engagement, and gate position are controlled to attain the requested unload rate. Fill strategy controller **238** controls the controllable subsystems **172** to nudge the position of grain cart **110** along container **118** to achieve a desired fill level within container **118**. Performing the unload operation is indicated by block **334** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6. Having grain cart-specific control system **220** control the gate position and engine speed based upon the commanded unload rate request in the master command is indicated by block **336**. Generating other control signals to perform the unload operation is indicated by block **338**.

[0160] Fill level detector **236** detects the fill level in container **118**, as indicated by block **340**, and fill strategy controller **238** generates nudge operations to execute a desired fill strategy, as indicated by block **342**. Until the unload operation is complete, as determined at block **344** (such as when the fill strategy is complete or the fill level reaches a desired level), processing reverts to block **334** where the unload operation is continued.

[0161] Once the unload operation is complete, then master control signal generator **240** issues a master command that commands the grain cart-specific control system **220** to perform a shutdown sequence, as indicated by block **346** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6. In one example, in order to perform the shutdown sequence, gate controller **252** first generates a control signal to control gate actuator **180** to close gate **111**, as indicated by block **348** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6. Clean out timer **254** then sets a clean out time so auger **112** continues to run for the clean out time with the gate **111** closed in order to clean out the auger **112**. Cleaning out the auger **112** is indicated by block **350**. Engine speed controller **246** then generates a control signal to reduce the speed of engine **170**, as indicated by block **352**, and PTO engagement controller **248** then disengages the power takeoff subsystem **262**, as indicated by block **354**. Engine speed controller **246** then increases the speed of engine **170** back to its prior speed, as indicated by block **356**, and auger/spout actuator controller **244** generates control signals to control the auger position actuator **176** and spout position actuator **178** to fold the auger to a desired position, as indicated by block **358** in the flow diagram of FIG. 6, and as is discussed in greater detail below with respect to FIG. 7.

[0162] FIGS. 7A and 7B (collectively referred to herein as FIG. 7) show one example of the operation of auger/spout actuator controller **244** in controlling the auger position actuator **176** and spout position actuator **178** to fold and unfold the auger **112** and spout **114**, as commanded. It is first assumed that grain cart **110** is a grain cart similar to that shown in FIGS. 2A-2C so that auger **112** and spout **114** can be moved through a plurality of different positions, including the road transport position, the field transport position, and the deployed, unload position. For purposes of the discussion of FIG. 7, it is assumed that auger **112** is initially in the road transport position, as shown in FIG. 2A, and as indicated by block **360** in the flow diagram of FIG. 7. Auger **112** is maintained in the road transport position until an unfold operation is to be performed, such as when an unfold master command is received from master control signal generator **240** of master control system **218**. Determining whether an unfold operation is to be performed is indicated by block **362** in the flow diagram of FIG. 7.

[0163] Once an unfold operation has been commanded, then auger/spout actuator controller **244** controls the auger position actuator **176** and spout position actuator **178** to exit the road transport position, as indicated by block **364**. This may include, for instance, releasing any holding mechanisms that are holding the spout **114** and auger **112** in the road transport position or other operations. Auger/spout actuator controller **244** then generates control signals to control the auger position actuator **176** to move the auger to the deployed, unload position shown in FIG. 2C, as indicated by block **366** in the flow diagram of FIG. 7. Auger/spout actuator controller **244** can use open loop control or determine that auger **112** is in the deployed, unload position based on feedback from auger/spout position sensors **268**, or in other ways. Once the auger **112** is in the deployed, unload position as determined at block **368**, then auger/spout actuator controller **244** controls the spout position actuator **178** to move the spout to the start unload position, as indicated by block **370**. Until the unload operation has started, as determined by block **372**, the spout and auger actuators are controlled to maintain the spout **114** and auger **112** in the deployed, unload position. To begin an unload operation, a master command will command the grain cart-specific control system **220** to engage the PTO, open the gate, etc. as discussed above

[0164] Once an unload operation has started, then fill strategy controller **238** generates a master command indicating when the landing point of material in container **118** should be moved. For instance, once fill level detector **236** determines that the fill level at a current landing point is at a desired level, then the spout **114** may be moved to redirect the trajectory of the material to change the landing point. In that case, a master command will be output to auger/spout actuator controller **244** indicating that the landing point should be changed in a desired way. Auger/spout actuator controller **244** then generates a control signal to control the spout position actuator **178** to move the spout to a position so that the landing point is at a commanded position, as indicated by block **374** in the flow diagram of FIG. 7. At the same time, fill strategy controller **238** will be generating nudge commands to nudge grain cart **110** along the side of the container **118** to load material into container **118** according to a desired fill strategy.

[0165] Once the unload operation is complete, as determined at block **376**, then auger/spout actuator controller **244** determines whether the auger **112** and spout **114** are to be folded during transport back to the harvester **102**. In some examples, it may be that the auger **112** and spout **114** need not be folded, but can remain in the deployed position as grain cart **110** travels back to the harvester **102**. In another example, it may be that the auger **112** and spout **114** are to be folded to the field transport position (such as that shown in FIG. 2B) or to another position. Determining whether the auger **112** and spout **114** are to be folded is indicated by block **378** in the flow diagram of FIG. 7. If not, processing reverts to block **370** where the spout actuator is controlled to move the spout **114** back to the start unload position and spout **114** is maintained in that position until another unload operation is started.

[0166] However if, at block **378**, it is determined that auger **112** and/or spout **114** are to be folded, then auger/spout actuator controller **244** generates control signals to move the spout **114** to the folded position, as indicated by block **380**, and auger/spout actuator controller **244** generates control signals to control the auger actuator **176** to move the auger **112** to the folded position, as indicated by block **382**. It will be noted that the auger **112** and spout **114** can either be folded to a road transport position or a field transport position (shown in FIGS. 2A and 2B, respectively). If the auger **112** is in the field transport position, as determined by block **384**, then the auger **112** and spout **114** are maintained in that position until an unfold operation is to be performed, as determined at block **386**. When an unfold operation is to be performed, then auger/spout actuator controller **244** again controls the spout actuator **178** and auger actuator **176** to exit the field transport position, as indicated by block **388**, and processing reverts back to block **366** where the auger **112** is moved to the deployed, unload position, as is the spout **114**, in preparation for another unload operation.

[0167] If, at block **384** it is determined that the auger **112** is not in the field transport position, then

it is determined whether the auger **112** is the road transport position, as determined at block **390** in the flow diagram of FIG. 7. Again, the position of the auger can be determined by auger/spout actuator controller **244** based on feedback from auger/spout position sensors **268** or in other ways. If, at block **390**, the auger **112** is not in the road transport position (nor is it in the field transport position as determined by block **384**), then processing reverts to block **382** where auger/spout actuator controller **244** continues to control the auger position actuator **176** and spout position actuator **178** to move auger **112** and spout **114** to either the field transport position or the road transport position. If, at block **390** it is determined that the auger **112** is in the road transport position, then processing reverts to block **360** in FIG. 7.

[0168] It can thus be seen that the present description describes a system in which a master control system can issue the same master commands to control a grain cart-specific control system to perform operations, even though the grain carts themselves vary widely in their functionality and configuration. The master control system need not be redesigned for different grain carts. Instead, the grain cart-specific control system can be configured using a grain cart model or grain cart configuration data to control a specific grain cart or type of grain cart based upon master commands generated by the master control system.

[0169] The present discussion has mentioned processors and servers. In one example, the processors and servers include computer processors with associated memory and timing circuitry, not separately shown. The processors and servers are functional parts of the systems or devices to which they belong and are activated by, and facilitate the functionality of, the other components or items in those systems.

[0170] Also, a number of user interface (UI) displays have been discussed. The UI displays can take a wide variety of different forms and can have a wide variety of different user actuatable input mechanisms disposed thereon. For instance, the user actuatable input mechanisms can be text boxes, check boxes, icons, links, drop-down menus, search boxes, etc. The mechanisms can also be actuated in a wide variety of different ways. For instance, the mechanisms can be actuated using a point and click device (such as a track ball or mouse). The mechanisms can be actuated using hardware buttons, switches, a joystick or keyboard, thumb switches or thumb pads, etc. The mechanisms can also be actuated using a virtual keyboard or other virtual actuators. In addition, where the screen on which the mechanisms are displayed is a touch sensitive screen, the mechanisms can be actuated using touch gestures. Also, where the device that displays them has speech recognition components, the mechanisms can be actuated using speech commands.

[0171] A number of data stores have also been discussed. It will be noted the data stores can each be broken into multiple data stores. All can be local to the systems accessing them, all can be remote, or some can be local while others are remote. All of these configurations are contemplated herein.

[0172] Also, the figures show a number of blocks with functionality ascribed to each block. It will be noted that fewer blocks can be used so the functionality is performed by fewer components. Also, more blocks can be used with the functionality distributed among more components.

[0173] It will be noted that the above discussion has described a variety of different systems, components, sensors, generators, detectors, timers, functionality, and/or logic. It will be appreciated that such systems, components, sensors, generators, detectors, timers, functionality, and/or logic can be comprised of hardware items (such as processors and associated memory, or other processing components, some of which are described below) that perform the functions associated with those systems, components, sensors, generators, detectors, timers, functionality, and/or logic. In addition, the systems, components, sensors, generators, detectors, timers, functionality, and/or logic can be comprised of software that is loaded into a memory and is subsequently executed by a processor or server, or other computing component, as described below. The systems, components, sensors, generators, detectors, timers, functionality, and/or logic can also be comprised of different combinations of hardware, software, firmware, etc., some examples of which are described below.

These are only some examples of different structures that can be used to form the systems, components, sensors, generators, detectors, timers, functionality, and/or logic described above. Other structures can be used as well.

[0174] FIG. 8 is a block diagram of agricultural system **100**, shown in FIG. 1, except that it communicates with elements in a remote server architecture **500**. In an example, remote server architecture **500** can provide computation, software, data access, and storage services that do not require end-user knowledge of the physical location or configuration of the system that delivers the services. In various examples, remote servers can deliver the services over a wide area network, such as the internet, using appropriate protocols. For instance, remote servers can deliver applications over a wide area network and they can be accessed through a web browser or any other computing component. Software or components shown in previous FIGS. as well as the corresponding data, can be stored on servers at a remote location. The computing resources in a remote server environment can be consolidated at a remote data center location or they can be dispersed. Remote server infrastructures can deliver services through shared data centers, even though they appear as a single point of access for the user. Thus, the components and functions described herein can be provided from a remote server at a remote location using a remote server architecture. Alternatively, the components and functions can be provided from a conventional server, or they can be installed on client devices directly, or in other ways.

[0175] In the example shown in FIG. 8, some items are similar to those shown in previous FIGS. and they are similarly numbered. FIG. 8 specifically shows that grain cart control configuration system **168**, and data store **162** and/or other systems **506** can be located at a remote server location **502**. Therefore, agricultural system **100** accesses those systems through remote server location **502**.

[0176] FIG. 8 also depicts an operator **505** and another example of a remote server architecture. FIG. 8 shows that it is also contemplated that some elements of previous FIGS. are disposed at remote server location **502** while others are not. By way of example, data store **162** or system **168** can be disposed at a location separate from location **502**, and accessed through the remote server at location **502**. Regardless of where the items are located, the items can be accessed directly by agricultural system **100**, through a network (either a wide area network or a local area network), the items can be hosted at a remote site by a service, or the items can be provided as a service, or accessed by a connection service that resides in a remote location. All of these architectures are contemplated herein.

[0177] It will also be noted that the elements of previous FIGS., or portions of them, can be disposed on a wide variety of different devices. Some of those devices include servers, desktop computers, laptop computers, tablet computers, or other mobile devices, such as palm top computers, cell phones, smart phones, multimedia players, personal digital assistants, etc.

[0178] FIG. 9 is a simplified block diagram of one illustrative example of a handheld or mobile computing device that can be used as a user's or client's hand held device **16**, in which the present system (or parts of it) can be deployed. For instance, a mobile device can be deployed in the operator compartment of harvester **100** and/or towing vehicle **108**, for use in generating, processing, or displaying the control and configuration data. FIGS. 10-11 are examples of handheld or mobile devices.

[0179] FIG. 9 provides a general block diagram of the components of a client device **16** that can run some components shown in previous FIGS., that interacts with them, or both. In the device **16**, a communications link **13** is provided that allows the handheld device to communicate with other computing devices and under some examples provides a channel for receiving information automatically, such as by scanning. Examples of communications link **13** include allowing communication through one or more communication protocols, such as wireless services used to provide cellular access to a network, as well as protocols that provide local wireless connections to networks.

[0180] In other examples, applications can be received on a removable Secure Digital (SD) card

that is connected to an interface **15**. Interface **15** and communication links **13** communicate with a processor **17** (which can also embody processors or servers from other FIGS.) along a bus that is also connected to memory **21** and input/output (I/O) components **23**, as well as clock **25** and location system **27**.

[0181] I/O components **23**, in one example, are provided to facilitate input and output operations. I/O components **23** for various examples of the device **16** can include input components such as buttons, touch sensors, optical sensors, microphones, touch screens, proximity sensors, accelerometers, orientation sensors and output components such as a display device, a speaker, and or a printer port. Other I/O components **23** can be used as well.

[0182] Clock **25** illustratively comprises a real time clock component that outputs a time and date. It can also, illustratively, provide timing functions for processor **17**.

[0183] Location system **27** illustratively includes a component that outputs a current geographical location of device **16**. This can include, for instance, a global positioning system (GPS) receiver, a LORAN system, a dead reckoning system, a cellular triangulation system, or other positioning system. The location system can also include, for example, mapping software or navigation software that generates desired maps, navigation routes and other geographic functions.

[0184] Memory **21** stores operating system **29**, network settings **31**, applications **33**, application configuration settings **35**, data store **37**, communication drivers **39**, and communication configuration settings **41**. Memory can include all types of tangible volatile and non-volatile computer-readable memory devices. Memory **21** can also include computer storage media (described below). Memory **21** stores computer readable instructions that, when executed by processor **17**, cause the processor to perform computer-implemented steps or functions according to the instructions. Processor **17** can be activated by other components to facilitate their functionality as well.

[0185] FIG. **10** shows one example in which device **16** is a tablet computer **600**. In FIG. **10**, computer **600** is shown with user interface display screen **602**. Screen **602** can be a touch screen or a pen-enabled interface that receives inputs from a pen or stylus. Computer **600** can also use an on-screen virtual keyboard. Of course, computer **600** might also be attached to a keyboard or other user input device through a suitable attachment mechanism, such as a wireless link or USB port, for instance. Computer **600** can also illustratively receive voice inputs as well.

[0186] FIG. **11** shows that the device can be a smart phone **71**. Smart phone **71** has a touch sensitive display **73** that displays icons or tiles or other user input mechanisms **75**. Mechanisms **75** can be used by a user to run applications, make calls, perform data transfer operations, etc. In general, smart phone **71** is built on a mobile operating system and offers more advanced computing capability and connectivity than a feature phone.

[0187] Note that other forms of the devices **16** are possible.

[0188] FIG. **12** is one example of a computing environment in which elements of previous FIGS., or parts of it, (for example) can be deployed. With reference to FIG. **12**, an example system for implementing some embodiments includes a computing device in the form of a computer **810** programmed to operate as described above. Components of computer **810** may include, but are not limited to, a processing unit **820** (which can comprise processors or servers from previous FIGS.), a system memory **830**, and a system bus **821** that couples various system components including the system memory to the processing unit **820**. The system bus **821** may be any of several types of bus structures including a memory bus or memory controller, a peripheral bus, and a local bus using any of a variety of bus architectures. Memory and programs described with respect to previous FIGS. can be deployed in corresponding portions of FIG. **12**.

[0189] Computer **810** typically includes a variety of computer readable media. Computer readable media can be any available media that can be accessed by computer **810** and includes both volatile and nonvolatile media, removable and non-removable media. By way of example, and not limitation, computer readable media may comprise computer storage media and communication

media. Computer storage media is different from, and does not include, a modulated data signal or carrier wave. Computer storage media includes hardware storage media including both volatile and nonvolatile, removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other data. Computer storage media includes, but is not limited to, RAM, ROM, EEPROM, flash memory or other memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile disks (DVD) or other optical disk storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to store the desired information and which can be accessed by computer **810**. Communication media may embody computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other data in a transport mechanism and includes any information delivery media. The term “modulated data signal” means a signal that has one or more of its characteristics set or changed in such a manner as to encode information in the signal.

[0190] The system memory **830** includes computer storage media in the form of volatile and/or nonvolatile memory such as read only memory (ROM) **831** and random access memory (RAM) **832**. A basic input/output system **833** (BIOS), containing the basic routines that help to transfer information between elements within computer **810**, such as during start-up, is typically stored in ROM **831**. RAM **832** typically contains data and/or program modules that are immediately accessible to and/or presently being operated on by processing unit **820**. By way of example, and not limitation, FIG. **12** illustrates operating system **834**, application programs **835**, other program modules **836**, and program data **837**.

[0191] The computer **810** may also include other removable/non-removable volatile/nonvolatile computer storage media. By way of example only, FIG. **12** illustrates a hard disk drive **841** that reads from or writes to non-removable, nonvolatile magnetic media, an optical disk drive **855**, and nonvolatile optical disk **856**. The hard disk drive **841** is typically connected to the system bus **821** through a non-removable memory interface such as interface **840**, and optical disk drive **855** are typically connected to the system bus **821** by a removable memory interface, such as interface **850**.

[0192] Alternatively, or in addition, the functionality described herein can be performed, at least in part, by one or more hardware logic components. For example, and without limitation, illustrative types of hardware logic components that can be used include Field-programmable Gate Arrays (FPGAs), Application-specific Integrated Circuits (e.g., ASICs), Application-specific Standard Products (e.g., ASSPs), System-on-a-chip systems (SOCs), Complex Programmable Logic Devices (CPLDs), etc.

[0193] The drives and their associated computer storage media discussed above and illustrated in FIG. **12**, provide storage of computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules and other data for the computer **810**. In FIG. **12**, for example, hard disk drive **841** is illustrated as storing operating system **844**, application programs **845**, other program modules **846**, and program data **847**. Note that these components can either be the same as or different from operating system **834**, application programs **835**, other program modules **836**, and program data **837**.

[0194] A user may enter commands and information into the computer **810** through input devices such as a keyboard **862**, a microphone **863**, and a pointing device **861**, such as a mouse, trackball or touch pad. Other input devices (not shown) may include a joystick, game pad, satellite dish, scanner, or the like. These and other input devices are often connected to the processing unit **820** through a user input interface **860** that is coupled to the system bus, but may be connected by other interface and bus structures. A visual display **891** or other type of display device is also connected to the system bus **821** via an interface, such as a video interface **890**. In addition to the monitor, computers may also include other peripheral output devices such as speakers **897** and printer **896**, which may be connected through an output peripheral interface **895**.

[0195] The computer **810** is operated in a networked environment using logical connections (such as a controller area network—CAN, local area network—LAN, or wide area network WAN) to one or more remote computers, such as a remote computer **880**.

[0196] When used in a LAN networking environment, the computer **810** is connected to the LAN **871** through a network interface or adapter **870**. When used in a WAN networking environment, the computer **810** typically includes a modem **872** or other means for establishing communications over the WAN **873**, such as the Internet. In a networked environment, program modules may be stored in a remote memory storage device. FIG. **12** illustrates, for example, that remote application programs **885** can reside on remote computer **880**.

[0197] It should also be noted that the different examples described herein can be combined in different ways. That is, parts of one or more examples can be combined with parts of one or more other examples. All of this is contemplated herein.

[0198] Although the subject matter has been described in language specific to structural features and/or methodological acts, it is to be understood that the subject matter defined in the appended claims is not necessarily limited to the specific features or acts described above. Rather, the specific features and acts described above are disclosed as example forms of implementing the claims.

Claims

1. A computer implemented method of controlling a grain cart pulled by a propulsion vehicle, comprising: generating a master command with a master control system on the propulsion vehicle, the master command identifying a grain cart operation to be performed; receiving the master command at a grain cart-specific control system on the propulsion vehicle configured to generate a set of grain cart-specific commands based the master command; and generating a control signal with the grain cart-specific control system to control an actuator on the grain cart to execute the set of grain cart-specific commands.
2. The computer implemented method of claim 1 wherein generating the master command with the master control system comprises: detecting that the grain cart is in an unloading position relative to a container; generating, as the master command, a power-up command commanding the grain cart-specific control system to perform a power-up sequence; and generating the control signal with the grain cart-specific control system to perform the power-up sequence.
3. The computer implemented method of claim 2 wherein generating the control signal with the grain cart-specific control system to perform the power-up sequence comprises: generating control signals to control actuators on the grain cart to configure the grain cart for unloading material from the grain cart into the container.
4. The computer implemented method of claim 3 wherein the propulsion vehicle has an engine, and the grain cart has an unloading auger and further comprising: after the auger is in a deployed position to perform an unloading operation, generating an engine slow signal to slow a speed of the engine to a first speed; generating an engage pto signal to engage a power takeoff; and generating an engine fast signal to control the speed of the engine to a second speed, faster than the first speed.
5. The computer implemented method of claim 4 wherein the grain cart has a gate that opens to allow material to flow to the auger and wherein generating control signals to control actuators on the grain cart to configure the grain cart for unloading material from the grain cart into the container comprises: generating an open gate signal to control a gate actuator to move the gate into an open position.
6. The computer implemented method of claim 5 wherein generating a master command comprises generating an unload rate request indicative of a requested rate at which material is unloaded from the grain cart to the container, wherein generating the control signal with the grain cart-specific control system comprises: generating a gate actuator control signal to control a position of the gate based on the unload rate request.
7. The computer implemented method of claim 6 wherein generating a master command comprises generating an auger unfold command and wherein generating a control signal with the grain cart-specific control system comprises: generating an auger position control signal to control an auger

position actuator to move the auger to the deployed position based on the auger unfold command.

8. The computer implemented method of claim 7 wherein the grain cart includes a spout and a spout position actuator that positions the spout and wherein generating a control signal with the grain cart-specific control system comprises: generating a spout position control signal to control the spout position actuator to move the spout into the deployed position based on the auger unfold command.

9. The computer implemented method of claim 5 wherein generating the master command comprises: detecting that an unloading operation is complete; and generating, as the master command, a command for the grain cart-specific control system, to perform a power down sequence and further comprising generating the control signal with the grain cart-specific control system to perform the power down sequence.

10. The computer implemented method of claim 9 wherein generating the control signal with the grain cart-specific control system to perform the power down sequence comprises: generating a gate close signal to control the gate actuator to move the gate to a closed position; controlling the auger to run for a clean out time period; generating an engine slow signal to slow a speed of the engine to the first speed; generating a disengage pto signal to disengage the power takeoff; and generating an engine fast signal to control the speed of the engine to the second speed, faster than the first speed.

11. The computer implemented method of claim 10 wherein generating a master command comprises generating an auger fold command and wherein generating a control signal with the grain cart-specific control system comprises: generating an auger position control signal to control the auger position actuator to move the auger to the folded position based on the auger fold command.

12. The computer implemented method of claim 1 and further comprising: accessing grain cart-specific configuration values; and configuring the grain cart-specific control system, based on the grain cart-specific configuration values, to generate the grain cart-specific commands.

13. The computer implemented method of claim 12 wherein accessing grain cart-specific configuration values comprises: detecting a grain cart identifier identifying the grain cart; and downloading a grain cart model based on the grain cart identifier.

14. The computer implemented method of claim 12 wherein accessing grain cart-specific configuration values comprises: conducting a configuration user experience to receive user configuration inputs indicative of a configuration of the grain cart.

15. The computer implemented method of claim 14 wherein conducting a configuration user experience to receive user configuration inputs comprises: generating an interactive display; prompting, on the interactive display, user manipulation of an actuator on the grain cart; detecting configuration information based on the user manipulation of the actuator on the grain cart; and saving the configuration data corresponding to a grain cart identifier identifying the grain cart.

16. A control system on a propulsion vehicle for controlling a grain cart propelled by the propulsion vehicle, the control system comprising: a master control system configured to generate a grain cart independent master command identifying a grain cart operation to be performed; a grain cart-specific control system configured to receive the master command and generate a set of grain cart-specific commands based the master command to control an actuator on the grain cart to execute the set of grain cart-specific commands; and a grain cart control configuration system configured to access grain cart-specific configuration values and configure the grain cart-specific control system, based on the grain cart-specific configuration values, to generate the grain cart-specific commands.

17. The control system of claim 16 wherein the master control system comprises: a vehicle position control system configured to detect that the grain cart is in an unloading position relative to a container; an unload operation control system configured to generate, as the master command, a power-up command commanding the grain cart-specific control system to perform a power-up sequence.

18. The control system of claim wherein the master control system comprises: a fill strategy controller configured to detect when an unloading operation is complete; and an unload operation control system configured to generate, as the master command, a power down command commanding the grain cart-specific control system to perform a power down sequence.

19. The control system of claim 17 wherein the grain cart includes a gate and a gate actuator and further comprising an unload rate request generator configured to generate an unload rate request indicative of a requested rate at which material is unloaded from the grain cart to the container and wherein the grain cart-specific control system comprises: a gate controller configured to generate a gate actuator control signal to control the gate actuator to control a position of the gate based on the unload rate request.

20. A propulsion vehicle that propels a grain cart, comprising: an engine; a propulsion subsystem; a steering subsystem; a master control system configured to generate a master command, the master command identifying a grain cart operation to be performed; a grain cart-specific control system configured to receive the master command and generate a set of grain cart-specific commands based the master command; and a controller configured to generate a control signal to control an actuator on the grain cart to execute the set of grain cart-specific commands.
